



Ayanokouji Atsuomi's Monologue

WEALTH, POVERTY. FINANCIAL disparity.

Highly educated, poorly educated. Educational disparity.

Urban and rural areas. Regional disparity.

Disadvantaged young people, privileged old people. Generational disparity.

Japan is a disparate society. These are just a few instances I mentioned, but they truly represent the difference between heaven and hell. The important thing to remember is that not all realities are not stagnant. The poor can rise to become wealthy, and the wealthy can fall to become poor. For example, if you don't like regional disparities, you can move to the city.

Although I understood the logic, I had nothing. I was born in the countryside, extremely poor, and pitifully uneducated. I was not blessed with endurance, nor was I a hard worker.

If I had to name one aspect that would've made me a strong fighter, it'd be my youth. However, I didn't make the most of it and spent much of my time in idleness. You could say I had a slow paced life.

There was no bright future awaiting me, and there was a possibility that I would simply lead a miserable life. But I opened up the future with my own hands.

It was because I had something grander than others, That is — unbridled and ever-expanding “ambition.”

I will rise to the top and stand at the top of this country.

With that in mind, I continued living my life until today. That ambition was the only thing that sustained me throughout my life.

When I turned twenty-five, I faced my first tribulation.

I had saved up three million yen by working part-time jobs. With this, I would become a politician and a member of the Japanese parliament, and build up huge wealth and prestige.

A fleeting and poor dream. I underestimated the election and lost miserably. It'd be lucky if that was all, but since I didn't even reach the required number of votes, they confiscated all of the three million I slaved myself to collect.

The government was not only trying to solve poverty, it was also trying to create a clean political environment, combat the declining birthrate, raise wages, and fight for the “NO WAR” movement.

I assumed it wouldn't be difficult to get elected if I just went around carelessly spouting all the beautiful things I could come up with without giving them too much thought. However, that would be a shallow and stupid idea.

Everyone comes up with such shallow thoughts.

What's important to win elections is which organization you belong to and who you work under, and whether you can discern enemies and allies while being wrapped up in a long game.

What happened afterward? You thought I had fallen?

I joined the ruling party, the Citizens' Party, and began taking my first steps as a politician.

Yes, two years later, I once again put my name forward in an election and won. In two years' time, I had succeeded in getting into a position where it was possible to pour my whole life, heart, and soul into politics.

This may have made me a winner, but for me, getting elected wasn't the goal.

Above all, the world of politics isn't that easy.

No, in some ways it was the deepest and blackest world out there. No matter how ambitious I am, I'm just another young member of the parliament with no backing or power.

Most of the people who're able to rise to power are second and third-generation people who were given the right to do so at birth. The sons of big politicians who are ignorant, dumb, and unaware of the danger they are in, who keep repeating their insipid empty remarks on TV, day and night.

Sometimes, they've even made the transition from show business to politics, using only their face and name recognition. Most of them are nothing more than mascots, but they still have more potential than a "have-not" like me. It's ironic. How do I make a name for myself as a politician? My options were limited from the start.

I had to take on the dirty jobs that no one else wanted to do. If I failed, my political career would be cut short immediately, and in some cases, criminal charges would be filed against me.

By taking the initiative in undertaking these tasks, I gradually strengthened my presence within the party. Eventually, I was known as the hidden sword of "Naoe-sensei," who united many factions in the Citizen's Party. I didn't hesitate to commit any kind of evil deed—pandering to underage girls, bribery, and espionage activities for hostile organizations.

Once I was entrusted with this project, the boundaries between right and wrong were removed for the sake of success. There were times when I connected with the yakuza or lesser gangs and resorted to violent means.

I had no time to rest, and I continued challenging myself. Before long, I was gaining influence within the party, and at the age of 36, I had one foot in power. But... from here on out, to jump into the very center of the political world, I would need further achievements and transgressions.

A newborn baby, one-month-old.

The first time I saw my child through the glass, he was staring blankly at the ceiling. No special feelings came to mind.

If I had to say, the only feeling I felt was relief that the key to move the higher-ups had arrived.

I'd been waiting impatiently for this moment for almost a year.

"Health check complete."

"Any problems?"

"There are no problems at present. The results of the DNA analysis were a match."

Tabuchi, who had completed all the tests, gave his report while looking at the results of the detailed examination.

I see. We can't get caught in the preliminary phase. Because that had been cleared up, we can say that the first stage has been accomplished.

"We could have you come in direct contact with them now."

"No need. Start the experiment immediately, just as you've done with the previous children."